Slow Signal

Friday, November 6, 2026
Boston · High 68° · Low 63°

David Senra @FoundersPodcast · Nov 5

IDEAS & LIFE

A few surprising things I learned from reading about Eiichrio Oda, the creator of One Piece:

1. He slept 3 hours a night for 15 years.

2. He created the most successful manga of all time with more than 600 million copies in circulation.

3. He said he would have missed his parent's funeral because it conflicted with his work.

4. He is extremely private. He does not allow his face to be photographed and when he appears on video he has a giant fish avatar placed on his head.

5. When he hires a new editor the first thing he says to them is you need to be willing to die for One Piece.

6. His editor said he might someday encounter a writer more talented than Oda but he would never meet anyone who worked harder.

7. He doesn't want ideas, he wants criticism.

8. He would hand draw entire Disney animated movies to learn how to give his characters emotion.

9. He said he only saw his family once a week because family time was too relaxing.

10. He holds the Guinness World Record for the most copies published for the same comic book series by a single author.

11. He is often described as a maniac due to his unbelievable work ethic and inhuman daily habits.

12. He believes in having the least number of people possible touching the work.

13. He says he gets his best ideas by not sleeping or eating. He says humans can only come up with truly new ideas when they reach their limit.

14. He started working on One Piece when he was 22. He is still working on it at 51.

15. He once spent 12 consecutive hours on the telephone discussing a single story with his editor.

16. He has an extreme tolerance for repetition.

17. Imagination is the organizing force of his entire life.

18. He's a perfectionist who has repeatedly admitted that he cannot make himself work in a more efficient way, even when he desperately wants to.

19. He never finishes before a deadline. He equates using every available minute with giving his maximum effort.

20. He believes it's impossible to create something great unless you do everything yourself, attend to every detail, and test it exhaustively.

21. He believes the more experience he has the harder it is to create.

22. He was 4 when he decided to be a manga artist. He said he wanted to avoid ever having to get a real job.

23. He creates his work for an audience of exactly one person: himself at 15 years old.

25. He has dedicated his entire adult life to writing a story about freedom and adventure, while accepting an extraordinarily restrictive life in order to create it.

26. To this day he does not feel successful.

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Eiichiro Oda is a relentlessly obsessive creative genius who has devoted nearly every waking hour of his adult life to building one of the most extraordinary fictional universes ever imagined. You don't want to miss this episode:

David Senra @davidsenra · Nov 5 IDEAS & LIFE

Business is problems. The best companies are just highly effective problem-solving machines.

Travis Kalanick on why he loves problems:

"I don't think about problems in a negative way."

"I think about problems the way a math professor would think about a problem."

"A math professor without interesting problems to solve is a sad math professor."

"So you wanna create interesting things to solve. You wanna create problems to solve. You have to predict well the nature of the problem and your ability and capacity to solve it."

— @travisk

Mad In America @Mad_In_America · Nov 5 SCIENCE & HEALTH

FDA Clears New Phone App for “Negative Symptoms” of Schizophrenia

by Peter Simons on the Mad in America Substack

FDA clearance based on similarity to previous app for depression that failed primary endpoint & single study with conflicts of interest.

Mimi Morgan @mimikmorgan · Nov 5 BUILDING & MAKING

What’s stopping you from doing this at 72, ladies?

I’ve gotten my arms and shoulders in incredible shape doing free weights. It’s taken time but it’s been worth the effort. Started with 2 lbs, up to 10 and working on 12's.

Left shoulder has two partial tears, was frozen, impingement, unable to swing it for almost 5 years unless loaded up with L Dopa, both shoulders have some pretty bad osteoarthritis.

I was scheduled for shoulder surgery before my stroke & subsequent MRSA infection…surgery is no longer an option.

My point…it doesn’t stop me, low & slow building muscle, strengthening without causing injury.

Bonus, I look good sleeveless, even better in strapless. 😉

Secretary Kennedy @SecKennedy · Nov 5 BOOKS & FAITH

Recovery is possible, and faith can be a powerful part of the journey. At Sheepgate in Colfax, Iowa, I saw firsthand how faith-based recovery programs are helping Americans overcome addiction and rebuild their lives.

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That’s all for today.

All posts are from X, quoted in full as posted. Nine posts, September–November 2026. Compiled Friday, Nov. 6, ET.